

Understanding Claude. Day 2

What I'm taking into Day 2

1. Treat Claude as a predictor, not an oracle. Fluency $\neq$ truth.
2. Spend the context window like a budget.
3. Design the system – instructions, tools, permissions, verification.
4. Reach for tools whenever facts, freshness, or actions matter.
5. Verify anything that matters.

Claude Ecosystem

- **Claude App:** Chat, cowork, code – for conversational use and, in Cowork mode, file and task automation.
- **Claude Code in a terminal** – a command-line tool that lets developers delegate coding tasks to Claude directly from the terminal, integrated into their local dev workflow.
- **API** – programmatic access to Claude models for developers to build Claude into their own applications and products.

Claude API: Create an API key

- Sign in to the Claude Console: platform.claude.com
- Open the API keys page (Go to [Settings](#) → [API keys](#))
- Create a key
- Copy and store the key
- Set the key as an environment variable: `export ANTHROPIC_API_KEY="sk-ant-api03-..."`

Claude Code CLI

Project 1: Using Claude Code in Command Line

1. Unzip sample_project.zip and run Terminal in the project's folder
2. Open Claude Code by typing `claude`
3. Ask Claude: What does this project do, and how do I run its tests?
4. Look up a term (for example, token)
5. Run the checks with: `python test_glossary.py` (or `python3 ...`)
6. Let Claude fix the bug and verify the update

Claude Code CLI

Useful commands

1. **/help** List all available commands
2. **/init** Explore the codebase and generate a starter CLAUDE.md
3. **/clear** Wipe conversation history and start fresh
4. **/model** View or switch the active model
5. **/simplify** Review your recently changed files for issues and fix
6. **/usage** Show your plan's usage limits and current rate-limit status

Claude Code CLI

Useful links

1. <https://code.claude.com/docs/en/how-claude-code-works>
2. Claude Code cheatsheet: <https://support.claude.com/en/articles/14553413-claude-code-cheatsheet>
3. FAQ: <https://support.claude.com/en/articles/14554922-claude-code-user-faq>
4. Claude Code docs: <https://code.claude.com/docs/en/overview>

Claude Code CLI

Summary

- 1. /help** List all available commands
- 2. /init** Explore the codebase and generate a starter CLAUDE.md
- 3. /clear** Wipe conversation history and start fresh
- 4. /model** View or switch the active model
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Building an operational environment

**Harness = Tools + Knowledge + Observation + Action
Interfaces + Permissions**

- 1. Tools:** file I/O, shell, network, database, browser
- 2. Knowledge:** product docs, domain references, API specs, etc.
- 3. Observation:** git diff, error logs, browser state, sensor data
- 4. Action:** CLI commands, API calls, UI interactions
- 5. Permissions:** isolation, approval workflows, trust boundaries

Building an operational environment

Model

- Reasoning
- **'Driver'**

Harness

- Executing + providing context
- **'Vehicle'**